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# Cohen Has Fingers Crossed

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NEW ORLEANS—(SP)—If you could get a look at Andy Cohen's New Orleans Pelican lineup list for opening day against the Mobile Bears, you probably would see question-marks at first, third, shortstop, catcher and the mound.

For Cohen, the former New York Giants infielder, the well-worn gag, "What's on First?" isn't a laughing matter.

The Birds have been training at Huntsville, Texas, with about 50-odd prospective players going through the paces. And if a half dozen of them stick around for opening day on April 10, Cohen will have migraine headaches.

Of course, he just might have to go to the post with a wet-behind-the-ear lineup, for Joe L. Brown, general manager of the Pittsburgh Pirates, recently said the Pels shouldn't expect any help from the Bucs.

"You'll have to depend," warned Brown, "on your help coming from our Hollywood (Coast league) farm. As it stands now, the pitchers and outfielders with us will be around for a while."

About the only near-ready spot is in the outfield. Back for another shot with the Pels is Johnny Powers, who played half of the '55 season with the Pels and the other with Williamsport, where he hit .309. Cohen believes Jolting John will be better than in '55 and should be one of the few big guns in the Pelican attack.

Also back is Ray Swarts, who played centerfield jore last year. Ray was having a good year until the tailend of the season when he seemed to tire. He's a year older now and appears to be in excellent shape.

Swarts, however, may be eased to play third base this year, because there just isn't another third sacker in camp. Cohen is crossing his fingers, hoping to get a hot cornerman from Hollywood.

The third outfield candidate is Emil Parda, who came to spring camp heralded as a home run producer who has been producing well.

At first base is promising, but untested Dutch Van Burkleo. When spring training started, Dutch didn't even figure in the Pel plans, but nothing better has come along, and Dutch has been giving it the old college try. He'll be at first when the season opens, Cohen says. Dutch, incidentally, is a service returnee and played only a few games at Waco before the season ended last year.

Earl Weaver, who was the starting of last year's infield, has the second base job all to himself. His fielding has been



Lenny Yochim
*Veteran Southpaw Returns*


John Powers
*Expected To Supply Power*

superb. The big question is his hitting.

Dick Barrone looks like the shortstop. He just arrived at Huntsville, so Cohen doesn't know much about him. But he comes highly recommended.

Dave Jacobs is the utility star and might get the call to play first if Van Burkleo falters. Jacobs was a .312 hitter with Burlington of the Carolina loop where he drove in 100 runs.

Lenny Yochim and Don Urquhart comprise the pitching staff. Yochim won a dozen games last year as a Pel. Urquhart, used mostly in relief, quit the team at midseason and went into retirement. Len is on the injured list at camp but Don has been doing extremely well. One of the two will open against the Bears.

Harry Fisher, pinch hitter par excellence a few years back, is back in camp as a pitcher-outfielder. He also figures to be Cohen's No. 1 pinch hitter.

After those three, Cohen has to scratch around—unless Hollywood comes up with help.

Another big change in the Pelican operation is their new general manager. Vince Rizzo, former scout for the Chicago Cubs. Rizzo was Pel general manager during the prosperous years that followed World War II.

Another new addition is Larry Gilbert, one of the league's outstanding managers and front office men. Larry, who was part owner of the Nashville Vols until last season, returns to the club he helped win many pennants in the 1930's.

But Gilbert will not be very active. He's on the board of directors, and will serve in an advisory capacity.

That's the picture, from the front office to the field.

Cohen's prediction?

"I'll reserve that until I see what kind of help we'll get from above."

## Rick Botelho Shines

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all the way from second, being safe only because of an error at the plate.

Landendefer doubled to left and scored when Larry Taylor's grounder was bobbled by Bobby Deakin at short.

Drummond was still on the hill when the three-run eighth rolled around. He started his own trouble by walking Purdue. Then Werber singled to right and Brown walked to load the sacks. Williams lined into a double play at second but Schmees drove a long double off the center field wall to plate two men and Landendefer's third double got Schmees across.

The game was by far the best the Vols have played in recent days and sends them into Sulphur Dell for a final three days of work before the opener.

The team will travel all day today but will work out at 11 a.m. Saturday at the Dell. A game with the State penitentiary is set for Sunday morning at the pen, then another light workout.

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Larry Taylor went hitless in four trips last night, but still wound up the spring activities with the team's best average. He has 15 hits in 34 times at bat.

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Purdue's best pitching last night came in the seventh to protect a one-run lead. John Jacuk led off the inning with a triple but stayed on third as Ray Coleman rolled out, Jerry McKay struck out and Bob Deakin fired to center.

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Rookie record after last night shows 20 innings pitched this spring, with 11 runs scored by the opposition on 15 hits. Five of the runs came in one game against the Cincinnati B team, four of them in one inning. The rookie left hander has been invincible the rest of the time.

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Second Baseman Jimmy Hagan was forced out of the Val Lloyd last Tuesday because of a groin injury and is being kept on the sideline because of a bruised finger.

He hurt the finger without knowing it in a game last Monday at Brooksville, Fla., and has been unable to take batting practice the last couple of nights because he cannot grip a bat.

Because Baltimore Manager Stanley Woods problem of selecting his second baseman more complex, White had hoped to look at Jimmy and Charlie Williams the same amount of time in the trip home, but Williams has had to play in the last three games.

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This will be good news to Tommy Brown's supporters. His injured leg is okay. There was practically no swelling yesterday, and Tommy wanted to play last night, but White vetoed it, except as a pinch hitter. Brown will next be in action on opening night Tuesday against Chattanooga.

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Paid attendance at Wednesday night's game in Fort Walton Beach between the Vols and Panola was 457.

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